

The Scarlet Witch — Mono-Red Big Mana

Bracket 3 · 3/3 Game Changers · no infinite combos · V2 promoted 2026-09-08

Lands 33 (22 basic)	Instant/Sorceries 37	Discounted (MV 4+) 24 (17 fixed + 7 X)	X-spells 7	Creatures 14	Avg MV 3.45
Mana engines 6	Draw 13	Protection 6	Removal/Defence 8	Win conditions 9	Game Changers 3 / 3

COMMANDER (1)

1 The Scarlet Witch  3

LANDS (33)

1 Valakut, the Molten Pinnacle 
1 Nykthos, Shrine to Nyx 
1 War Room 
1 Rogue's Passage 
1 Tyrite Sanctum 
1 Forge of Heroes 
1 Castle Embereth 
1 Arena of Glory 
1 Shatterskull Smashing 
1 Valakut Awakening 
1 Mines of Moria 
22 Mountain 

RAMP — ROCKS, RITUALS AND COST REDUCTION (13)

1 Sol Ring  1
1 Arcane Signet  2
1 The Fire Crystal  4
1 Ruby Medallion  2
1 Pyromancer's Goggles  5
1 Pyretic Ritual  2
1 Desperate Ritual  2
1 Seething Song  3
1 Jeska's Will  3
1 Mana Geyser  5
1 Brass's Bounty  7
1 Artist's Talent  2
1 Gauntlet of Power  5

RAMP — PER-SPELL MANA ENGINES (6)

1 Electro, Assaulting Battery  3
1 Urabrask  4
1 Ashling, Flame Dancer  4
1 Neheb, the Eternal  5
1 Storm-Kiln Artist  4
1 The Vision and Scarlet Witch  4

CARD DRAW & SELECTION (13)

1 Big Score  4
1 Unexpected Windfall  4
1 Inspired Tinkering  5
1 Commune with Lava  2
1 Ignite the Future  4
1 Hex Magic  3
1 Wiccan, Young Avenger  4
1 Wheel of Fortune  3
1 Reforge the Soul  5
1 Will of the Jeskai  4
1 The One Ring  4
1 Hit the Mother Lode  7
1 Gamble  1

THEME / SYNERGY — PUMP HER POWER TO GROW THE DISCOUNT (3)

1 Livaan, Cultist of Tiamat  3
1 Blackblade Reforged  2
1 Runechanter's Pike  2

THEME / SYNERGY — COPY AND RECUR (4)

1 Mizzix's Mastery  4
1 Past in Flames  4
1 Repeated Reverberation  4
1 Arcane Bombardment  6

DAMAGE CONVERSION — PINGERS, BOOSTERS AND BURN (4)

1 Guttersnipe  3
1 Nico Minoru, Runaway  4
1 Fated Firepower  3
1 Boltwave  1

PROTECTION (6)

1 Deflecting Swat  3
1 Return the Favor  2
1 Conqueror's Flail  2
1 Champion's Helm  3
1 Mithril Coat  3
1 Commander's Plate  1

REMOVAL & DEFENCE (8)

1 Chaos Warp  3
1 Kazuul, Tyrant of the Cliffs  5
1 Vandalblast  1
1 Untimely Malfunction  2
1 Zuko's Exile  5
1 Fiery Confluence  4
1 Volcanic Vision  7
1 Disrupt Decorum  4

WIN CONDITIONS (9)

1 Crackle with Power  2
1 Chandra's Ignition  5
1 Thor, God of Thunder  5
1 Longshot, Rebel Bowman  4
1 Fiery Inscription  3
1 Storm King's Thunder  3
1 Electrodominance  2
1 Jaya's Immolating Inferno  2
1 Fiery Emancipation  6

Build history — 23 substitutions made to finalize this list

IN		Artist's Talent {1}{R} Class. L1: loot on every noncreature spell. L2 ({2}{R}): noncreature spells cost {1} less. L3 ({2}{R}): your noncombat damage to opponents gets +2.	↔	Improvisation Capstone {5}{R}{R} Exile from the top until total MV 4+, cast any free. Paradigm: a free copy each first main phase.	OUT 
Why: A THIRD cost reducer behind Ruby Medallion and Longshot — only two exist in mono-red — plus looting that feeds Past in Flames, plus +2 to every damage instance. With Ruby out it costs just {R}. Capstone strip-mines your library every turn and you permanently lose whatever you can't cast, and its free-cast forces X=0.			Bring back: Long, grindy games where recurring free digs beat a cost reducer.		
IN		Ashling, Flame Dancer {2}{R}{R} 4/4. Keeps unspent red mana across steps. Loots on every instant/sorcery; 2nd resolution each turn deals 2 to each opponent and their creatures; 3rd adds {R}{R}{R}{R}.	↔	Fellwar Stone {2} {T}: Add one mana of any colour a land an opponent controls could produce.	OUT 
Why: A build error being corrected. In mono-red, Fellwar Stone often cannot produce {R} at all — and the deck has {R}{R} and {R}{R}{R} costs throughout. Ashling both fixes flood (loot every spell) and produces mana.			Bring back: Tables where every opponent plays red.		
IN		Castle Embereth — Enters untapped if you control a Mountain. {T}: Add {R}. {1}{R}{R}, {T}: Creatures you control get +1/+0.	↔	Cori Mountain Monastery — Enters tapped unless you control a Plains or an Island. {T}: Add {R}. {3}{R}, {T}: impulse the top card.	OUT 
Why: Cori's untapped clause names Plains and Island — in a mono-red deck it ALWAYS enters tapped. Castle Embereth enters untapped off any of your 21 Mountains and still taps for red, with a pump ability that adds to Wanda's discount.			Bring back: Never — the condition can't be met in mono-red.		
IN		Champion's Helm {3} Equipped creature gets +2/+2 and, while it's legendary, has hexproof. Equip {1}.	↔	Swiftfoot Boots {2} Equipped creature has hexproof and haste. Equip {1}.	OUT 
Why: A swap, not redundancy — hexproof does not stack. Haste is worth nothing here because Wanda's discount is a STATIC ability that works the moment she resolves. The +2/+2 is +2 off every discounted spell, and 10 of our 12 creatures are legendary.			Bring back: Artifact-removal-heavy pods, or if you want haste for the Blackblade commander-damage line.		

IN



Conqueror's Flail {2}

Equipment. Equipped creature gets +1/+1 for each color among permanents you control. While attached to a creature, your opponents can't cast spells during your turn. Equip {2}.



Hexing Squelcher {1}{R}

2/2. This spell can't be countered. Ward—pay 2 life. Spells you control can't be countered. Other creatures you control have ward—pay 2 life.



OUT

Why: The lockout shuts off counterspells AND instant-speed removal on the only turn that matters, from an Equipment your own sweepers can't kill. The pump is a flat +1/+1 here — mono-red, and colorless isn't a color — so the second ability is the whole card. Squelcher's on-turn coverage was a subset of this, on a 2/2 that dies to your own Fiery Confluence and Chandra's Ignition. **PLAY NOTE:** equip a spare body (Robot token, Storm-Kiln Artist), not Wanda — she's the removal magnet and the lockout only needs the Flail attached to A creature.

Bring back: For counterspell-heavy pods wanting all-turns protection — but then it comes in for Champion's Helm, not the Flail.

IN



Disrupt Decorum {2}{R}{R}

Goad all creatures you don't control — until your next turn they must attack, and must attack someone other than you.



Blazing Crescendo {1}{R}

Target creature gets +3/+1. Exile the top card of your library; you may play it until the end of your next turn.



OUT

Why: Reversal of an earlier bad cut. The deck had NO way to avoid being attacked, and red gets no fogs. Goad is a one-sided fog that also points the table at each other. Crescendo was outclassed by Monstrous Rage anyway — same +3/+1 for half the mana, plus a permanent +1/+1 Role.

Bring back: If you want a sixth pump effect.

IN



Fiery Confluence {2}{R}{R}

Choose three, repeats allowed: 1 damage to each creature / 2 damage to each opponent / destroy target artifact.



Insurrection {5}{R}{R}{R}

Untap all creatures and gain control of them until end of turn. They gain haste.



OUT

Why: MV 4, so Wanda drops it to {R}{R} — six damage to each opponent for two mana, or a three-damage sweeper. Insurrection is six mana after the discount, wins through COMBAT (the one axis this deck isn't built for), and is blank against a creature-light table.

Bring back: Creature-heavy boards worth stealing. Note it is NOT a defensive card — it's a sorcery and can't answer an attack.

IN



Fiery Emancipation {3}{R}{R}{R}

Triples all damage from sources you control.



Solphim, Mayhem Dominus {2}{R}{R}

5/4. Doubles all noncombat damage you deal to opponents and to permanents they control. Can give itself an indestructible counter.



OUT

Why: Reversed 2026-08-04. The gap is ONE mana, not two: Longshot reduces noncreature spells, so it applies to Emancipation ({1}{R}{R}{R} with Ruby + Longshot) but not to a creature like Solphim. The triple also lets X be smaller — 40 damage needs Crackle at X=4 under a doubler but only X=3 under a tripler, three mana back on the payoff. And an enchantment survives a format that runs far more creature removal than enchantment removal; Solphim's indestructible costs {1} + 4 life + discarding two cards and doesn't stop exile.

Bring back: If you want the cheaper body and can protect it.

IN



Fiery Inscription {2}{R}

Whenever you cast an instant or sorcery, deals 2 damage to each opponent. On entry, the Ring tempts you.



Double Vision {3}{R}{R}

Whenever you cast your first instant or sorcery each turn, copy it.



OUT

Why: Three mana for 2 to each opponent per spell — a five-spell turn is 30 damage across the table — and being an enchantment it survives the removal that kills Thor and Longshot. Double Vision was five mana to copy a single spell per turn.

Bring back: Grindy games where you cast one spell a turn for many turns.

IN



Gauntlet of Power {5}

Choose a colour. Creatures of that colour get +1/+1. Whenever a BASIC land is tapped for that colour, its controller adds an additional one.



Monstrous Rage {R}

Target creature gets +2/+0 and a Monster Role token (+1/+1, trample).



OUT

Why: Choose red and all 21 Mountains tap for {R}{R} — roughly doubling your land mana, and the surplus BANKS under Electro or Ashling. Two caveats: it only affects BASIC lands, and it's symmetric, so check for opposing Mountains.

Bring back: If you want a fifth pump effect instead.

IN



Hex Magic {2}{R}

Exile your whole hand, draw that many, and you may still play the exiled cards until the end of your next turn.



Rousing Refrain {3}{R}{R}

Add {R} for each card in target opponent's hand, retained until end of turn. Suspend 3—{1}{R}.



OUT

Why: Rousing Refrain scales off your OPPONENTS' hand sizes — dead against a table that has dumped its grip. Hex Magic is reliable, cheaper, and effectively doubles your available cards for the turn.

Bring back: Full-grip tables: control, counterspell decks, Rhystic/Remora pods. Three opponents holding four cards each is 12 red mana.

IN



Hit the Mother Lode {4}{R}{R}{R}

Discover 10. If the discovered card's MV is less than 10, create that many tapped Treasures.



Bolt Bend {3}{R}

Costs {3} less if you control a creature with power 4 or greater. Change the target of target spell or ability with a single target.



OUT

Why: About three mana after reducers. Crucially the undiscovered cards go to the BOTTOM of your library rather than being exiled, and 'or put it into your hand' lets you dodge the X=0 trap on an X-spell — the exact failure mode that Apex of Power has. Bolt Bend was the third redirect and the least flexible.

Bring back: When you want the cheapest possible redirect.

IN



Iron Man, Tony Stark {3}{R}{R}

3/3 flying. Attacking creatures you control get +1/+0. Whenever you cast a RED spell, create a 2/1 colorless Robot Hero artifact creature token with flying.



Apex of Power {7}{R}{R}{R}

Exile the top seven cards; you may cast them until end of turn. If cast from your HAND, add ten mana of any one color.



OUT

Why: Apex adds its ten mana ONLY if cast from hand, so it was dead off Past in Flames / Mizzix's Mastery / Will of the Jeskai in a deck built to recur sorceries. Seething Song nets the same +4 mana for 1 mana instead of 6. Its exile window also ends THAT TURN, where every other impulse effect here lasts until the end of your next turn — that is what cost a real game. Iron Man is a third win axis: a 2/1 flier per red spell, and Fiery Emancipation triples COMBAT damage too (six Robots = 12 -> 36).

Bring back: If you want the widest single dig and accept losing whatever you can't cast.

IN



Jaya's Immolating Inferno {X}{R}{R}

Legendary sorcery. Deals X damage to each of up to three targets. You may cast it only if you control a legendary creature — Wanda always qualifies.



Pirate's Pillage {3}{R}

Discard a card as an additional cost. Draw two cards and create two Treasure tokens.



OUT

Why: Added after a playtest where Apex of Power exiled the only table-killer. The deck had exactly ONE card that could kill three players at once (Crackle with Power) — Storm King's Thunder is a copier and Electrodominance hits a single target, so Jaya's is the SECOND table-killer, not a fourth X-spell as originally filed. Pirate's Pillage is the cleanest cut in the deck: identical text to Big Score at the same cost, but a sorcery. Draw drops 12 to 11, still above average.

Bring back: If you find yourself card-starved rather than damage-starved.

IN



Kazuul, Tyrant of the Cliffs {3}{R}{R}

5/4. Whenever a creature an opponent controls attacks, if you're the defending player, create a 3/3 red Ogre token unless that creature's controller pays {3}.



Abrade {1}{R}

Choose one — 3 damage to target creature, or destroy target artifact.



OUT

Why: Defence was the deck's one structural weakness and Kazuul is the only fix that produces blockers WHEN YOU NEED THEM — the trigger resolves during declare attackers, so the 3/3 Ogres can block that same combat. Either they pay {3} per attacker or you build a board; both are good. Abrade is mana value 2 so Wanda never discounts it, and 3 damage kills very little in Commander. Note: your own Chandra's Ignition kills Kazuul once Wanda's power is 4+.

Bring back: Artifact-heavy pods, or tables of small utility creatures worth killing at instant speed.

IN



Mines of Moria —

Enters untapped if you control a legendary creature. {T}: Add {R}. {3}{R}, {T}, Exile three cards from your graveyard: Create two Treasures.



Demolition Field —

{T}: Add {C}. {2}, {T}, Sacrifice: Destroy target nonbasic land an opponent controls; they may search for a basic.



OUT

Why: Colourless mana does NOT bank under Electro or Ashling, while red does — so a colourless land is worse twice over. Mines taps for red and enters untapped off any of the deck's ten legendary creatures.

Bring back: Against decks built on one key nonbasic land.

IN



Mithril Coat {3}

Flash. Indestructible. On entry, attach it to target legendary creature you control. Equipped creature has indestructible.



Blasphemous Act {8}{R}

Costs {1} less for each creature on the battlefield. Deals 13 damage to each creature.



OUT

Why: The deck had no answer to a board wipe: hexproof does nothing (a wrath doesn't target), Commander's Plate's protection doesn't stop a destroy effect and gives nothing vs red, and all three redirects need a spell with a single target. Mithril Coat has FLASH, so you hold it and deploy in response. Blasphemous Act was also the only sweeper that killed Wanda — and the claim it 'pairs with the damage doublers' fails, since 13 already kills everything and it deals no damage to players.

Bring back: Tables with LARGE creatures, where Chandra's Ignition at low power and Fiery Confluence at 3 don't get there.

IN



Neheb, the Eternal {3}{R}{R}

4/6 afflict 3. At the beginning of each of your postcombat main phases, add {R} for each 1 life your opponents have lost this turn.



Comet Storm {X}{R}{R}

Multikicker {1}. Deals X damage to each of up to 1 + kicks targets.



OUT

Why: A Fiery-Confluence turn hands you 18+ red mana in your second main phase. Comet Storm was redundant with Crackle with Power, which does the same job better.

Bring back: When you want a second instant-speed X-spell.

IN



Runechanter's Pike {2}

Equipped creature has first strike and gets +X/+0, where X is the number of instant and sorcery cards in your graveyard. Equip {2}.



Blazing Shoal {X}{R}{R}

You may exile a red card with mana value X from your hand rather than pay the mana cost. Target creature gets +X/+0 until end of turn.



OUT

Why: A permanent +6 to +12 on Wanda off the graveyard the deck fills anyway, for {2} and equip {2} — the same discount Blazing Shoal gave for one turn at the cost of two cards. Pike + Blackblade is a one-swing kill through Rogue's Passage.

Bring back: Only for the pure one-big-turn shape, where a free +10 on the Crackle turn still matters.

IN



The Fire Crystal {2}{R}{R}

Red spells you cast cost {1} less. Creatures you control have haste. {4}{R}{R}, {T}: copy a creature you control until end of turn.



Mind Stone {2}

{T}: Add {C}. {1}, {T}, Sacrifice: Draw a card.



OUT

Why: A SECOND Ruby Medallion — word-for-word the same reduction line. Cost reducers are the one category where redundancy is unambiguously right: they stack additively and never blank each other. NOTE only {2} of its cost is generic, so Ruby + Longshot take it to {R}{R} and Artist's Talent L2 then does nothing — it is 3 mana in practice, never 1. Mind Stone was the last pure-colourless rock and its mana does NOT bank under Electro or Ashling.

Bring back: If the curve feels top-heavy — this trades a two-drop for a three-drop.

IN



Urabrask {2}{R}{R}

4/4 first strike. Whenever you cast an instant or sorcery, deals 1 to target opponent AND adds {R}. Flips into a Saga once you've cast three in a turn.



Molten-Core Maestro {1}{R}

Opus — whenever you cast an instant/sorcery, put a +1/+1 counter on it. If 5+ mana was spent, add {R} equal to its power.



OUT

Why: Measured, not guessed: Maestro's mana ability needs 5+ mana SPENT, and only 6 of 37 fixed-cost instants/sorceries still cost that much after a 2-power discount. Wanda's discount actively turns it off — the better she is, the less it triggers. Urabrask's {R} is unconditional.

Bring back: Only if the deck somehow stops discounting.

IN



Volcanic Vision {5}{R}{R}

Return an instant/sorcery from your graveyard to hand; deals damage equal to that card's MV to each creature YOUR OPPONENTS control. Exiles itself.



Wild Ricochet {2}{R}{R}

Change targets of target instant/sorcery, then copy it.



OUT

Why: MV 7 → {3}{R}{R}. Return Apex of Power and it's a 10-damage ONE-SIDED wipe plus the regrowth — it doesn't kill your own engines. Wild Ricochet was the fourth redirect behind Deflecting Swat, Bolt Bend and Return the Favor.

Bring back: Spell-heavy pods where redirect-and-copy earns its slot.

IN



Wiccan, Young Avenger {3}{R}

3/3. Whenever you cast a noncreature spell, exile the top card of your library — you may play it until your next end step.



Call Forth the Tempest {5}{R}{R}{R}

Cascade, cascade. Deals damage to each creature opponents control equal to the total MV of your other spells this turn.



OUT

Why: Impulse card advantage on EVERY noncreature spell — a six-spell turn draws six extra cards, for 24 cents. Tempest was eight mana with a random cascade.

Bring back: Creature-heavy boards where the sweep half matters.

Sideboard — what to bring in, and when



Abrade {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Kazuul, vs artifact-heavy pods or tables of small utility creatures. Mana value 2, so Wanda never discounts it.



Ancient Tomb land

Bring in: IN for Gamble — a straight Game Changer swap, the cap is three. Left on 2026-09-08: 2 life a turn, and colourless mana does not bank under Electro or Ashling. A Mountain under Gauntlet of Power taps for {R}{R} and costs no life. Losing it costs the turn-2 Wanda opener, about 8% of games. It is the third Game Changer in DECK-V3.md, where speed is the whole plan.



Apex of Power {7}{R}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Iron Man. Widest single dig in the pool, but adds mana ONLY from hand and anything uncast is exiled permanently.



Birgi, God of Storytelling {2}{R}

Bring in: IN for The Vision and Scarlet Witch or any per-spell engine. Same trigger ({R} per spell, banked); the Vision grows into a threat and Birgi's boast text is blank here. Its back face, Harnfel, is a real card-advantage engine the deck never used.



Blasphemous Act {8}{R}

Bring in: IN for Volcanic Vision, vs boards with LARGE creatures where Chandra's Ignition at low power and Fiery Confluence at 3 don't get there. Costs {1} less per creature on the battlefield — often {R}. Remember it kills Wanda too.



Blazing Crescendo {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Monstrous Rage, if you want a sixth pump. Outclassed — Monstrous Rage is the same +3/+1 for half the mana and leaves a permanent +1/+1 Role.



Blazing Shoal {X}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Runechanter's Pike, only for the pure one-big-turn shape where a free +10 on the Crackle turn beats a permanent +6 to +12.



Bolt Bend {3}{R}

Bring in: IN for Return the Favor. Costs {3} less with a 4-power creature, so usually just {R} — but it's redirect ONLY. Return the Favor can copy opponents' spells and abilities.



Bulk Up {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Boltwave in grindy pods where Blackblade Reforged or Runechanter's Pike is already sitting on Wanda. Doubles her power, so it doubles the discount AND Chandra's Ignition, which reads her power directly — at 12 power that is 24 to each opponent and each other creature. Flashback {4}{R}{R}. Dead on an unpumped 2/3, which is why it is not maindeck here; it IS maindeck in DECK-V3.md, where the seeds guarantee a base. Sequencing: equip first, then double.



Cait Sith, Fortune Teller {3}{R}

Bring in: IN for a pump slot. The +X/+0 arrives at the beginning of combat, which is the wrong timing for a deck that spends its mana in the main phases — Livaan triggers on every cast instead.



Call Forth the Tempest {5}{R}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Apex of Power, vs creature-heavy boards. Cascade twice, then damage to each creature opponents control equal to the total MV of your other spells this turn.



Cori Mountain Monastery —

Bring in: Enters tapped unless you control a Plains or an Island — in mono-red that means ALWAYS tapped. Displaces Castle Embereth if you ever want the impulse ability anyway.



Crawlspace {3}

Bring in: IN for Kazuul, vs heavy creature aggro. No more than two creatures can attack you each combat. Its edge over Kazuul: it's an ARTIFACT, so your own Fiery Confluence and Chandra's Ignition can't kill it — every creature-based defence plan folds to your own sweepers. Lost on price (\$9.93 vs \$0.34).



Demolition Field —

Bring in: IN for Mines of Moria, vs decks leaning on one key nonbasic (Gaea's Cradle, Cabal Coffers, Nykthos). Legal at Bracket 3 — only MASS land denial is barred. It does hand them a basic in exchange.



Fellwar Stone {2}

Bring in: IN for Mind Stone, only at tables with red opponents. In mono-red it often cannot produce {R} at all, and the deck has {R}{R} and {R}{R}{R} costs throughout.



Improvisation Capstone {5}{R}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Arcane Bombardment if you want recurring free digs. Paradigm gives a free copy every first main phase — but it strip-mines your LIBRARY and anything you don't cast stays exiled, and its free-cast forces X=0.



Insurrection {5}{R}{R}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Chandra's Ignition, vs creature-heavy boards worth stealing. NOT a defensive card — it's a sorcery, so it cannot answer an attack.



Mind Stone {2}

Bring in: IN for The Fire Crystal if you want the cheaper rock back. Colourless, so it does not bank under Electro or Ashling.



Comet Storm {X}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Electrodominance, when you want a second instant-speed X-spell. Multikicker {1} per extra target.



Coruscation Mage {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Fiery Inscription, vs low-interaction tables where a chip clock survives. Offspring {2} gives a second body. Dies to any wipe.



Darksteel Plate {3}

Bring in: IN for Return the Favor, when you want a SECOND indestructible source. Five mana all-in and no flash, so it's strictly worse than Mithril Coat.



Double Vision {3}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Repeated Reverberation, in grindy games where you cast one spell a turn for many turns. Copies only your FIRST instant/sorcery each turn.



Hexing Squelcher {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Champion's Helm, vs counterspell-heavy pods where you want uncounterable on ALL turns — a flashed Mithril Coat or Deflecting Swat can still be countered, and Conqueror's Flail only locks your own turn. Fragile: your own Fiery Confluence and Chandra's Ignition kill the 2/2.



Increasing Vengeance {R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Repeated Reverberation if you want the cheaper cast. Fifth-best of five copiers here — copies are not cast, so it never triggers a pinger — but it is maindeck in DECK-V3.md, where copying beats converting.



Iron Man, Tony Stark {3}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Boltwave or Guttersnipe if you want a combat axis back. A 2/1 flier per red spell; its Robots die to your own Fiery Confluence creature mode and Chandra's Ignition. Modal DFC — the Iron Man face is castable straight from hand.



Molten-Core Maestro {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Storm-Kiln Artist, only if the deck somehow stops discounting. Its mana ability needs 5+ mana SPENT, and only 6 of 37 fixed-cost spells cost that after a 2-power discount — Wanda actively turns it off.



Monstrous Rage {R}

Bring in: IN for Blackblade Reforged if you want a fifth pump. +2/+0 plus a Monster Role for a permanent +1/+1 — one mana for a permanent +1 to the discount.



Nova Flame {X}{2}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Volcanic Vision, vs creature decks. The +1/+1 counters on Wanda are PERMANENT, so the discount grows — but it deals no damage to players and can't close.



Pinnacle Monk {3}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for a Mountain, if you keep flooding or getting land-screwed. The spell half is a CREATURE, so Wanda never discounts it, and Mystic Peak isn't a Mountain — it turns off Valakut and adds no Nykthos devotion.



Pirate's Pillage {3}{R}

Bring in: IN for Big Score, if you want a third draw-two-plus-Treasures. Word-for-word identical to Big Score at the same cost, but a SORCERY instead of an instant — strictly the worst of the three.



Prisoner's Dilemma {3}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Fiery Confluence, vs pods that enjoy politics. 4/8/12 damage to each opponent, but THEY choose the outcome.



Rousing Refrain {3}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Mana Geyser, vs full-grip tables — control, counterspell decks, Rhystic Study / Mystic Remora pods. Three opponents holding four cards each is 12 red mana. Dead against aggro.



Runaway Steam-Kin {1}{R}

Bring in: Cheapest engine in the pool. Rate matches Electro (1 mana per spell) — the old 'caps at three' objection was wrong. Out on fragility: a 1/1 that dies to your own Fiery Confluence.



Scavenger Grounds —

Bring in: Graveyard hate, but symmetric — and YOUR graveyard feeds Past in Flames, Will of the Jeskai and Mizix's Mastery. Colourless too. Displaces a Mountain only vs a dedicated graveyard deck.



Sokenzan, Crucible of Defiance —

Bring in: IN for a Mountain. Taps for red, but it isn't a Mountain so it never triggers Valakut, and its channel makes two hasty 1/1s in a deck that doesn't attack.



Solphim, Mayhem Dominus {2}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Fiery Emancipation if you want the cheaper deploy. Doubles instead of triples, and it's a CREATURE — dies to the removal every deck has. Its indestructible costs {1} + 4 life + discarding two cards, and doesn't stop exile.



Swiftfoot Boots {2}

Bring in: IN for Champion's Helm, vs artifact-removal-heavy pods, or when you want haste for the Blackblade commander-damage line. Hexproof does not stack.



Tablet of Discovery {2}{R}

Bring in: IN for Runechanter's Pike if your graveyard is exiled too often for the Pike to hold its size. The fifth 1–3-mana rock behind Sol Ring, Signet, Ruby and Fire Crystal, with 33 lands.



Wild Ricochet {2}{R}{R}

Bring in: IN for Untimely Malfunction, vs spell-heavy pods. Redirect AND copy. It was the fourth redirect behind Deflecting Swat, Bolt Bend and Return the Favor.



Witch's Mark {1}{R}

Bring in: IN for Monstrous Rage, in grindy tables where the extra card beats tempo. MV 2 so no discount, but the Wicked Role is a permanent +1 to Wanda's power.

The chain build — DECK-V3.md

A separate Bracket 3 list built around the Livaan + X-spell recurrence, not a swap path from this one. With Livaan out, an X-spell costs only its coloured pips and roughly doubles Wanda before it resolves (X counts toward mana value on the stack, CR 202.3e), so every X-spell is a pump as well as a payoff. Turn 5, five Mountains: Storm King's Thunder at X=2 for {R}{R}{R} puts her at 7, then Jaya's Immolating Inferno at X=7 for {R}{R}, copied twice, is 21 to each opponent — 55 with one Bonesplitter down first. That list trades this one's per-cast damage layer (Guttersnipe, Fiery Inscription, Nico Minoru, Fated Firepower, Fiery Emancipation) for nine cheap Equipment seeds and eleven doublers. Mechanism and simulation: research/turn-5-chain-2026-09-08.md. Import list: MOXFIELD-V3.txt.

Seeds it adds 	Bonesplitter {1} +2/+0, equip {1}. The cheapest real seed — and a seed is multiplied by every link after it.	Fiery Emancipation {3}{R}{R}{R} Triples all your damage.	What it drops 
Why: Six mana to triple a turn that already deals hundreds. A fair-turn card in a deck that is not playing a fair turn.	Why: Never, in the chain list.		

Seeds it adds 	Hero's Blade {2} +3/+2, and it re-attaches free whenever a legendary creature you control enters — every Wanda recast.	Nico Minoru, Runaway {3}{R} 2 to each opponent per spell cast from anywhere but hand.	What it drops 
Why: Same reason, plus her free-cast forces X = 0 on the deck's own X-spells.	Why: Grindy pods.		

Seeds it adds 	Lunar Frenzy {X}{R} Target creature you control gets +X/+0, first strike and trample.	Fated Firepower {X}{R}{R}{R} +X to every damage instance you deal an opponent.	What it drops 
Why: One red pip doubles Wanda with no engine on the board — the redundancy for Livaan, who is otherwise one card in 99. Frantic Confrontation is the second copy.	Why: Never, in the chain list.		

Seeds it adds 	Shuko {1} +1/+0, equip {0} — free to re-suit every time Wanda is recast.	Guttersnipe {2}{R} 2 damage to each opponent per instant/sorcery cast.	What it drops 
Why: Per-cast damage scales with the number of casts. A chain turn is few casts and many copies, and copies are not cast.	Why: Whenever the deck goes back to grinding.		

Seeds it adds 	Storm King's Thunder {X}{R}{R}{R}{R} Copy your next instant or sorcery X times. Both lists run it; only the chain list leads with it.	Neheb, the Eternal {3}{R}{R} {R} per life lost, at your postcombat main.	What it drops 
Why: Neheb's mana arrives after damage and after combat. The chain spends everything in the first main phase.	Why: If the deck ever wants a combat step again.		

Discount = Wanda's power + Ruby Medallion + Longshot, generic only, MV 4+ only. Crackle: X costs 3 generic each and deals 5X. X=8 is 40 = a kill from full. Free-casting an X-spell forces X=0; cost reduction does not. X counts toward mana value ON THE STACK (CR 202.3e), which is why Livaan turns every X-spell into a pump. Full pilot notes in research/gameplan.md, research/formulas.md and research/turn-5-chain-2026-09-08.md.

SCARLET WITCH — PILOT'S GAMEPLAN

How to actually play the deck, turn by turn and board state by board state. Written for the locked 100 in `DECK.md`. Companion math sheet: `formulas.md`.

0. The one-paragraph version

You are **not** a creature deck and you are **not** a storm deck. You are a **cost-reduction engine that fires one enormous spell**. Wanda makes every instant and sorcery of mana value 4+ cheaper by her power, so your whole game is: survive, grow her power, generate a pile of red mana in a single turn, then convert that mana into damage with an X-spell. Every card in the deck is there to do one of four jobs — **make mana, draw cards, grow Wanda, or be the payoff**. If a play doesn't advance one of those four, don't make it.

The mental reframe: stop asking "what can I cast?" Ask "**how much does everything cost right now, and how much mana can I make this turn?**" The gap between those two numbers is your whole deck.

1. The 60-second cheat sheet

START OF TURN

- say the DISCOUNT out loud: "Wanda X + Ruby 1 + Longshot 1 = N off generic"
- did I draw Reforge the Soul first? MIRACLE it for {1}{R}
- The One Ring: tap to draw (remember the burden counters)

PRECOMBAT MAIN

1. Wanda first if she isn't out — nothing matters more
2. Per-spell mana engines (Electro / Birgi / Urabrask / Storm-Kiln)
3. Livaan / pump — TARGET WANDA
4. Card draw
5. Rituals last
6. If Neheb is out: deal damage NOW (Fiery Confluence, pingers)

COMBAT

- usually don't attack; just pass through to reach postcombat

POSTCOMBAT MAIN

- Neheb trigger: {R} per 1 life opponents lost this turn (EMPTIES at end of phase)
- THE X-SPELL GOES HERE
- $(\text{mana} - 2 \text{ red pips} + \text{total reduction}) \div 3 = X$
- 5X is the damage. 40 = a kill from full. Solphim halves the X you need.

HOLD FOREVER

- Deflecting Swat (free with commander)
- Mithril Coat (flash — for the wrath)
- Runechanter's Pike: equip Wanda on a quiet turn — +1 discount per instant/sorcery in the yard, permanently
- Mana Geyser (until they're tapped out)

NEVER

- free-cast an X-spell ($X = 0$)
- cast Crackle "big but not lethal"
- wheel a good hand

2. The one formula that governs everything

Every instant or sorcery you cast at mana value 4 or greater costs:

$\text{printed cost} - \text{Wanda's power} - 1 \text{ (Ruby Medallion)} - 1 \text{ (Longshot)} \dots \text{generic only}$

Reductions **only eat generic mana**. The coloured pips (🔴🔴 on Crackle, 🔴🔴🔴 on Apex) are untouchable. Everything under mana value 4 gets **no discount from Wanda at all** — Ruby Medallion and Longshot still apply.

Say the number out loud before every big spell. In your playtest you forgot Wanda's own 3 and cast Crackle at X=7 instead of X=9. That's 10 damage per target, thrown away.

3. What actually kills people, ranked

A. The X-spell (your primary win con). One spell, whole table.

Card	What it does	The number that matters
Crackle with Power	5×X damage to each of up to X targets	X=8 is 40 — a kill from full
Jaya's / Comet Storm (<i>sideboard</i>)	X to three / X+kicks targets	backup Crackles
Chandra's Ignition	Wanda's power to each other creature and each opponent	needs Wanda pumped; also a one-sided-ish wipe
Apex of Power	exile 7 and cast them by paying , + 10 mana of one colour	a <i>mana engine</i> , not a free-cast — see the Apex rule in §6

B. Per-spell chip damage. These turn a long turn into a kill without a payoff card:

Card	Trigger	Damage
Thor, God of Thunder	each noncreature spell you cast	equal to that spell's mana value — 4 to 11 a pop
Longshot, Rebel Bowman	each noncreature spell you cast	2 to each opponent, <i>and</i> 1 off everything
Fiery Inscription	each instant/sorcery you cast	2 to each opponent

C. The multiplier. **Solphim** doubles all noncombat damage you aim at opponents and their permanents. It halves the X you need. Nothing else in the deck is a multiplier — one is enough.

D. Commander damage (backup only). Blackblade Reforged plus Rogue's Passage. Take this line only when the X-spell plan is dead.

4. The three numbers you track

Everything else is noise. Track these:

Number 1 — WANDA'S POWER (the discount)

Base 2. It goes up from:

- **Livaan** — +X/+0 where X is the mana value of the noncreature spell you just cast. ****Always**

point it at Wanda. **** Cast a 5-drop, she's +5 for the turn.**

- **Cait Sith** — +X/+0 each combat, X = the exiled card's mana value.
- **Runecanter's Pike** — +X/+0 where X = instants and sorceries in your graveyard; equip 2. Permanent — ~+6 to +12 by turn 7 — but Past in Flames / Will / Mizzix's / Bombardment exile the yard and shrink it.
- **Monstrous Rage** — +3/+1 and a **permanent** +1/+1 Role.
- **Blackblade Reforged** — +1/+1 per land. Equip is 3 because she's legendary, not 7.
- **Forge of Heroes / Tyrite Sanctum** — permanent +1/+1 counters.

Permanent pumps compound. A Forge counter is a mana saved on every X-spell for the rest of the game. One-turn pumps only matter on the turn you go off.

Number 2 — RED MANA AVAILABLE THIS TURN

Lands + rocks + rituals + per-spell engines. The per-spell engines are the ones people undercount:

- **Electro, Assaulting Battery** — 2 per instant/sorcery, ****and you keep all unspent red mana**

across steps and phases**

- **Birgi** — 2 per *spell* (creatures and artifacts too), kept until end of turn
- **Urabrask** — 2 per instant/sorcery, plus 1 damage
- **The Vision and Scarlet Witch** — 2 per spell, and it grows itself
- **Storm-Kiln Artist** — a Treasure per instant/sorcery cast **or copied**
- **Neheb** — 2 per 1 life your opponents lost this turn, at your **postcombat** main

Number 3 — CARDS LEFT IN HAND

You run out of cards long before you run out of mana. That's what Wiccan, The One Ring, Hex Magic, Big Score, Commune with Lava and the wheels are for. If you're at 15 mana and 1 card, you have a card problem, not a mana problem.

5. Turn-by-turn: the opening

T1–T3 — do nothing flashy

Land, Sol Ring, Arcane Signet, Mind Stone, Ruby Medallion. **Cast Wanda around turn 3.** She's a 2/3 that does nothing visible, which is exactly what you want — nobody removes her early because she looks harmless. Every turn she's out is a turn your spells are 2 cheaper.

Do not cast a ritual on turn 2 just because you can. Rituals are for the turn you go off.

T4–T5 — build the discount, find cards

Priorities in order: a **per-spell mana engine** (Electro, Birgi, Urabrask) > **Wiccan / The One Ring** for cards > a **pump** on Wanda > a payoff you're holding.

This is also when you cast **Fiery Inscription** or **Longshot** — they're cheap, they accumulate, and they make the eventual turn lethal instead of merely large.

T6+ — look for the turn

You want, all at once: **12+ mana available, 3+ cards in hand, a payoff, and one protection spell up**. See §8.

Mulligans

Keep any hand with 3+ lands and either a rock or Wanda-plus-a-cheap-engine. **Ship** hands with 5+ lands and no engine, or 2 lands and no rock — this deck's curve genuinely needs 4–5 lands and you can't operate on 2. **Never keep** a hand whose only action is a 7-drop. You will die holding it.

6. The HOLD list — "don't cast this yet"

This is the section that separates a good pilot from a bad one. Every card below is a trap if cast on curve.

Card	HOLD unless...	Why
Mana Geyser	your opponents are tapped out	It counts <i>their</i> tapped lands. Cast it in your main phase after a big turn cycle, not on an empty board. It's often 0–3 mana on turn 4 and 12+ on turn 8.
Rousing Refrain (sideboard)	opponents are holding cards	Scales off <i>their</i> hand size. Dead against a table that's dumped its grip.
Wheel of Fortune / Reforge the Soul	your hand is 2 cards or fewer — or the table is holding sculpted hands you want gone	You're refilling <i>yourself</i> . Wheeling with 5 good cards hands three opponents a fresh 7 and gains you nothing.
Reforge the Soul	(exception) you draw it as your first card of the turn	Miracle 1🔮 — cast it immediately for two mana. Watch for this every draw step.
Deflecting Swat	someone targets you or Wanda	It's free with your commander out. There is no reason to ever cast it proactively. Hold it every single turn.
Mithril Coat	a wrath or a removal spell is on the stack	It has flash . Casting it on your own turn wastes its entire point.
Bolt Bend	Wanda has 4+ power	It costs 3 less with a 4-power creature — so 🔮 instead of 3🔮. Pump first, then it's nearly free.
Chandra's Ignition	Wanda's power is 6 or more	At base 2 power it deals 2. It's a finisher, not a removal spell. Pump, <i>then</i> Ignite.
Blackblade Reforged	you have 5 spare mana and a plan	2 to cast plus 3 to equip is a whole turn that deals no damage. Deploy it on a turn you weren't going to go off anyway.
Disrupt Decorum	you're about to be attacked, or you're the archenemy	Goad lasts until your next turn , so cast it in <i>your</i> main phase to cover the whole cycle back to you.
Past in Flames	your graveyard has 3+ spells worth recasting	It's a payoff, not a cantrip. Casting it with an empty yard is a wasted card.
Improvisation Capstone	you're going to have main phases left to use the Paradigm copies	The free copy each first main phase is most of the card's value.
Apex of Power	you have mana left <i>after</i> casting it to deploy what it finds	It exiles 7 and anything you don't cast that turn is gone forever . It is NOT a free-cast — you pay normally, which is why it gives you ten mana. Cast it early in the turn, never last, and cast the cards you'd most hate to lose first. Crackle exiled this way is castable at a real X — pay for it. Commune with Lava and Ignite the Future are safer (until end of your <i>next</i> turn).
The One Ring	you need the protection turn, or you need cards	" <i>Protection from everything until your next turn</i> " is a fog for the whole table's attacks . Sometimes the right play is casting it purely to not die.
Vandalblast	you can overload it (4🔮) profitably	Single-target for 🔮 is fine in a pinch, but overloading is a blowout. Don't fire it at a Sol Ring.
Ancient Tomb	you actually need the second mana	It deals you 2 every activation. At 40 life that's fine; at 12 it's a real cost. Tap Mountains first when the extra mana doesn't change what you cast.

And the mirror image — the CAST IT NOW list

- **Wanda herself**. Every turn she isn't out is a turn everything costs 2 more.
- **Ruby Medallion, Longshot, Fiery Inscription**. Cheap, permanent, compounding.
- **Livaan**. It's 3 mana and it turns every subsequent spell into a discount.
- **Runechanter's Pike** — 2 (free after Longshot + Artist's Talent); equip Wanda on a quiet turn. It only gets bigger.
- **Reforge the Soul off the top** — miracle for 1🔮.

7. The X-spell rules you must not forget

Three categories, and they behave completely differently:

- ✔ **Paying a real cost** → **X works**. Hard-casting. Flashback and escape where the cost equals the mana cost — **Past in Flames**, **Will of the Jeskai**, **Underworld Breach** (B4). Wanda still discounts these.
- ✔ **Copying a spell on the stack** → **X carries over, free**. **Pyromancer's Goggles**, **Increasing Vengeance**, **Repeated Reverberation**, **Return the Favor**, **Storm King's Thunder**. The copy keeps your X and can **re-use the same targets** — the "no duplicate targets" rule is per spell, and a copy is a separate spell.
- ✗ **Free-casting** → **X = 0, deals nothing**. **Improvisation Capstone**, **Mizzix's Mastery**, **Electrodominance**, **Arcane Bombardment**. If Apex exiles **Crackle with Power**, **do not cast it** — put it in hand if the effect allows, or cast something else.

The one-liner: if you're paying a cost, X works. If you're paying nothing, X is zero.

8. The go-off checklist — do I start this turn?

Before you cast the first ritual, confirm **all five**. If any is missing, don't start — you'll dump your hand and die holding an empty board.

1. **Mana**. Count lands + rocks + rituals + engine output. Write the number down.
2. **Cards**. 3+ in hand, or a draw spell you can cast first (Wiccan out counts double).
3. **The payoff**. **Crackle** / **Ignition** / **Thor in play** / a copy effect on a payoff. Naming which one.
4. **The number**. Do the division: (mana – 2 red pips) ÷ 3 = your X. Is 5X enough?
5. **The window**. One protection spell up — **Deflecting Swat** (free), **Mithril Coat**, or **Bolt Bend** —

or the knowledge that nobody at the table is holding interaction.

If you can kill exactly one player, that's often still correct — but kill the one who's closest to winning, not the one who's most annoying.

9. Sequencing — order of operations within your turn

The order matters more in this deck than almost any other. The default:

1. PRECOMBAT MAIN
 - a. Cast Wanda if she isn't out. Nothing else matters more.
 - b. Deploy per-spell mana engines **FIRST** (**Electro** / **Birgi** / **Urabrask** / **Storm-Kiln**). Every spell after this point makes mana.
 - c. Deploy pump (**Livaan**) **BEFORE** the expensive spells, so they grow her on the way.
 - d. Cheap card draw (**Big Score**, **Wiccan** already out) to see more of the deck.
 - e. Rituals **LAST** — they're mana you can't hold, so spend them into the payoff.
 - f. If **Neheb** is out: deal your damage **HERE** (**Fiery Confluence**, pinger triggers).
2. COMBAT

Usually you don't attack. Go to combat anyway — the phase happens regardless and you need to reach your postcombat main.
3. POSTCOMBAT MAIN
 - g. **Neheb** triggers: {R} for each 1 life your opponents lost this turn.
 - h. **THIS** is where the X-spell goes. Count your reducers, do the division, cast it.

Why Neheb rewrites the turn

Neheb gives red mana at the **beginning of your postcombat main phase**, equal to total life your opponents lost that turn. So the shape is: **burn precombat, collect postcombat, kill postcombat**.

That mana **empties at end of phase** — you cannot hold it into your end step or anyone's turn. Use it or lose it.

Two Goggles reminders

- Tap **Pyromancer's Goggles** and spend *that specific* 🗑️ on the spell, or no copy.
- Goggles produces one 🗑️ per turn, so **one copy per turn cycle** — unlike the copy *spells*,

which stack freely.

10. Scenario library

🎯 Scenario 1 — Turn 6, 14 mana available, Crackle in hand, Wanda at 2

Reducers: Wanda 2, Ruby Medallion 1. That's 3 🗑️ **off generic**.

14 mana – 2 (red pips) = 12 generic. 12 + 3 reduction = 15 generic budget. 15 ÷ 3 = X=5.

X=5 is **25 damage to each of up to 5 targets** — 75 across the table. Not a kill from 40, but it puts everyone in one-shot range and you've spent one card.

Better line: don't cast it. Spend the turn on Livaan + a mana engine + a draw spell, and cast Crackle next turn at X=8 for the actual kill. **Crackle is at its worst as a "big but not lethal" spell** — it announces you as the threat and gets you killed before your next turn.

🌟 Scenario 2 — Your playtest board (the real one)

Wanda at 3, Ruby Medallion, Longshot, Goggles, Neheb, 24 mana in your postcombat main.

Reducers: **3 + 1 + 1 = 5 off.**

24 - 2 red pips = 22 generic. 22 + 5 = 27 budget. 27 ÷ 3 = X=9.

X=9 is 45 damage to each of up to 9 targets. You cast X=7 for 35. The habit that fixes it: say "Longshot one, Ruby one, Wanda three — five off" out loud before you lock X.

🔥 Scenario 3 — You have Goggles and a modest Crackle

Goggles copies the spell and the copy **keeps X and can re-use targets**. So X=2 with Goggles is 10 + 10 to the *same* two players — **20 each** — for about 4 mana after reducers.

This is your best *early* Crackle. Two players at 20 is a completely different game than three players at 40, and it costs almost nothing.

With Solphim out, that same line is 40 to each of two players — two people dead for four mana.

🛡️ Scenario 4 — A wrath is on the stack

Hexproof (Champion's Helm) and protection (Commander's Plate) **both do nothing** — a wrath neither targets nor deals damage.

Your answers, in order: flash in **Mithril Coat** (this is the entire reason it's in the deck) → **Tyrite Sanctum's** indestructible counter if you set it up → accept it and rebuild.

If Wanda dies, she's cheap to recast (the tax climbs by 2 each time) and **you should recast her immediately** — the discount is worth more than any other 3-drop.

⚔️ Scenario 5 — You're about to be attacked by a big board

Disrupt Decorum. Goad everything you don't control; they must attack, and must attack someone other than you. It buys the exact turn you need. Cast it in *your* main phase — goad runs until your next turn, so it covers the whole cycle.

Second option: **The One Ring** for protection from everything until your next turn. That's a fog for the entire table and it draws you cards afterwards.

Third: **Volcanic Vision** returning a big spell — damage equal to its mana value to each creature *your opponents control*, one-sided, and it doesn't kill your engines.

If Kazuul is already down, you may not need any of them. Every attacking creature costs its controller 3 or hands you a 3/3 Ogre, and the trigger resolves during **declare attackers** — so the Ogres exist before blockers are declared and can block that same combat. Against three attackers that's either 9 out of their turn or three 3/3 blockers. Two things to remember:

- **It's a tax, not a prevention.** They can pay. A deck with mana open will just pay and swing.
- **Your own Chandra's Ignition kills Kazuul** once Wanda's power is 4 or more, and a 3-power

Ignition kills the Ogres. If you're holding Ignition as your kill, the Ogres are for *surviving to* that turn, not for blocking on it. Fiery Confluence at 3 does **not** kill Kazuul (5/4), but it does kill every Ogre.

🗡️ Scenario 6 — Wanda has been killed twice and the tax is 6

Don't chase her. At 2🔴 + 4 tax she's a 7-mana 2/3.

Play the deck without the discount for a turn. Your cheap spells still work — Fiery Confluence is 2🔴🔴, Big Score is 3🔴, Longshot and Thor still ping. Recast her when it's convenient, or when you're going off anyway and the 3 discount pays for the tax within the same turn.

🌐 Scenario 7 — You resolve Apex of Power and see Crackle with Power in the exile

Do not cast it. Free-casting forces X=0. Cast the other six cards, and if Apex's wording gives you the choice, take Crackle to hand instead. The 10 mana Apex adds is what makes *next* turn's hard-cast Crackle enormous.

🗨️ Scenario 8 — Big graveyard, Will of the Jeskai in hand

Will of the Jeskai gives everything in your yard **flashback equal to its mana cost** — which for an X-spell **includes X**, so you get to choose a real X.

Best line: cast the X-spell once, let it hit the yard, *then* Will of the Jeskai and flash it back bigger with the mana you've accumulated. You get two X-spells out of one card.

Also: with your commander out, Will of the Jeskai takes **both** modes. Don't forget the wheel half.

🏠 Scenario 9 — You're flooded: 20 mana, 1 card in hand

You have a **card** problem. Do not cast the ritual.

Priority: **The One Ring** (draws increasingly many) → **Hex Magic** (doubles your hand for a turn) → **Commune with Lava** for a big X → **War Room** → **Apex of Power** (see 7 cards *and* 10 mana — but you *PAY* for what you cast, and lose the rest).

Apex is the best flood-breaker in the deck precisely because it converts excess mana into cards.

💧 Scenario 10 — Someone else is about to win

Your interaction is thin and mostly proactive. In rough order:

Chaos Warp the problem permanent (only unconditional answer) → **Untimely Malfunction** to redirect their kill spell or blank an attack → **Deflecting Swat** (free!) to redirect the spell that wins the game → **Vandalblast** overloaded if it's an artifact deck → **Disrupt Decorum** to turn their board on each other.

Do not hold your X-spell hoping to race. If you can't kill the table, kill *them*.

🎯 Scenario 11 — Choosing targets for Crackle

Targets must all be **different** — you cannot double up on one player. And **damage per target is fixed at 5X regardless of how many you choose**, so picking fewer doesn't concentrate it.

Order of preference: **players closest to winning** → **players in range of your chip damage next turn** → **problem creatures** you can't otherwise remove. Remember that "any target" includes planeswalkers and battles.

🕒 Scenario 12 — Turn 4, you drew Reforge the Soul as your first card

Miracle it for 1 🗑️ immediately. Everyone discards and draws seven. You're the one with a mana engine and a 3-mana commander; a fresh seven cards is worth far more to you than to them. **The other reason to wheel:** it's hand denial — the blue player's held counterspell and the combo player's assembled hand go to the graveyard before your kill turn, and seven random cards rarely include the exact answer again. Reforge at 🗑️🗑️ with Wanda out (MV 5) or Wheel of Fortune at 🗑️ the turn before you go off is the closest thing mono-red has to a discard spell.

🔪 Scenario 13 — Thor and Longshot are both out

Every noncreature spell you cast now deals **its mana value (Thor) plus 2 to each opponent (Longshot)**. A five-spell turn averaging mana value 5 is 25 damage focused plus 30 spread — before any payoff.

This is when you don't need Crackle at all. Chain cheap spells and let the triggers kill. Also note: **Goggles copies do NOT trigger these** — a copy isn't cast.

🔥 Scenario 14 — Solphim is on the battlefield

Halve every damage number you were planning. X=4 Crackle becomes 40 to each of four. Fiery Confluence becomes 12 to each opponent for two mana. Chandra's Ignition on a 6-power Wanda becomes 12 to each opponent *and* 12 to every other creature.

With Solphim out, look for the kill a full turn earlier than you otherwise would.

🌋 Scenario 15 — You have Valakut, the Molten Pinnacle and 5+ other Mountains

Every Mountain you play from here deals **3 damage to any target**. That's a free 3 a turn, it feeds Neheb, and it closes games you thought were out of reach. Count it before deciding you can't get there — and if you're holding two Mountains, that's 6.

11. Threat assessment — who do you point at?

You get **one** big turn. Spend it on the right person.

1. **Whoever is closest to winning**, even if they're at high life. You're the only one who can hit

all three at once; use that on the person a normal deck can't answer.

1. **Whoever is holding up blue mana**, if you're forced to choose. Your combo turn dies to one counterspell and you only have Hexing Squelcher for that.

1. **Whoever has been attacking you**. Practical, not emotional — dead attackers stop the clock.
2. **Never** spend a whole turn killing the weakest player. You're not going to get a second one.

12. The checklist people forget

Before every big spell:

- ☐ **Wanda's power** — did you count it? (This is the one you missed.)
 - ☐ **Ruby Medallion 1 · Longshot 1**
 - ☐ Is the spell **mana value 4+**? If not, Wanda does nothing.
 - ☐ Is it an **X-spell being free-cast**? If so, X = 0 — don't.
 - ☐ Did you **tap Goggles and spend that 🗑️ on this spell**?
 - ☐ **Livaan** — target Wanda, not something else.
 - ☐ **Thor / Longshot / Fiery Inscription** — did you resolve their triggers on *every* spell?
 - ☐ **Storm-Kiln Artist** makes a Treasure on cast **and on copy**.
 - ☐ **Ashling** — second resolution each turn is 2 damage to each opponent, third is 🗑️🗑️🗑️.
 - ☐ Neheb mana **empties at end of phase**.
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13. Beginner mistakes to avoid

1. **Forgetting Wanda's own discount.** Costs you an entire X. Say the reducers out loud.
2. **Free-casting an X-spell.** Deals zero. The single worst blowout available to you.
3. **Casting Crackle "big but not lethal."** You become the archenemy and die before your next

turn. Either kill someone or wait.

1. **Casting rituals on curve.** Rituals are turn-of-the-kill cards, not ramp.
2. **Wheeling a good hand.** You're refilling three opponents for free.
3. **Casting Deflecting Swat proactively.** It's free — hold it forever.
4. **Casting Mithril Coat on your own turn.** It has flash. Hold it.
5. **Chandra's Ignition at 2 power.** Deals 2. Pump first.
6. **Attacking with Wanda for no reason.** She's a 2/3 that runs your entire deck. Leave her home

unless Blackblade + Rogue's Passage is the actual plan.

1. **Equipping Runechanter's Pike and then exiling your own graveyard.** Past in Flames, Will of the Jeskai, Mizzix's Mastery and Arcane Bombardment all shrink it — count what stays before you commit to the swing.
2. **Not counting Valakut triggers.** Three damage a Mountain adds up.
3. **Tapping Ancient Tomb when Mountains would do.** Two life a pop is real.

14. Playing V2 (DECK-V2.md, 2026-08-21) — what changes at the table

V2 exists because of one report: *eight turns of nothing, then very strong*. The list moved three slots into **spell** → **damage conversion** (Guttersnipe, Fated Firepower, Nico Minoru), one ritual- shaped slot into burn (Boltwave), and the tenth win condition into a tutor (Gamble). Everything in §§1–13 still applies; these are the overrides.

The reframe: you are no longer waiting for one enormous turn. With a converter out, every spell you cast is damage — so **turns 4–7 are spell-casting turns, not setup turns**.

- **Converter before engine.** On turns 3–5 the priority order is now: Wanda → **Longshot /

Fiery Inscription / Guttersnipe / Fated Firepower / Thor / Nico** → *then* Electro / Ashling / Urabrask → then draw. Two converters out turns a five-spell turn into 20–40 to each opponent without a payoff card. Gamble finds whichever piece you're missing — cast it on a **full hand** (1/N to bin the target; a binned instant/sorcery comes back via Past in Flames, Will, Thor's ETB or Volcanic Vision).

- **Rituals are deposits.** Once Electro or Ashling is out, cast and copy the rituals early and

bank the red — you already do this; V2 just writes it down. Spend it on the turn the converters are down.

- **Fated Firepower goes in at the end of an opponent's turn** (flash). $X = \text{your spare mana} - 3$

plus your reducer count; with Ruby + Fire Crystal + Longshot + Artist's Talent L2 out, $X=4$ costs 🍷🍷🍷. Every damage instance to an opponent or their permanents is then $+X$: Longshot $2+X$, Inscription $2+X$, Guttersnipe $2+X$, Boltwave $3+X$, Confluence $3 \times (2+X)$ each for 🍷🍷.

- **Say the per-spell number out loud** the way you say the discount: "Longshot 2, Inscription 2,

Guttersnipe 2, plus Firepower 4 each = 18 to each opponent per spell." Then count spells, not mana.

- **Nico Minoru** triggers on any cast from *not your hand*: Wiccan's exiles, impulse cards,

flashbacks, Mizzix's / Bombardment copies, Thor's ETB. Her own ability (2🍷, T, discard) free- casts off the top — **$X = 0$ on an X-spell** and you can't choose what it hits, so count the X-spells left in the library before you activate.

- **Confluence with pingers out:** take "2 to each opponent" three times (6 each, $3 \times (2+X)$ under

Firepower). The creature mode is one of three *choices* — it only kills your board if you pick it. **Chandra's Ignition is not a choice:** every creature pinger dies on the Ignition turn, after its cast trigger resolved. Enchantment converters (Inscription, Firepower) survive.

- **Blackblade on Wanda by turn 5 when drawn.** $+1/+1$ per land you *control* — 6–10 in practice,

not 33. Swing through Rogue's Passage when a player is within two hits (21 commander damage); the lost life also feeds Neheb postcombat. A one-player road, not a table kill — but it is the road that works on turn 6.

- **The X-spell is the closer, not the plan.** With three converters and Firepower out, a

three-spell turn is lethal without it. Crackle is for the turn you have it and the mana.

- **Mulligans:** V1's rule plus one — a hand with a converter and Wanda is a keep on four lands;

a hand of pure mana is now a ship, not a keep.

SCARLET WITCH — COST & DAMAGE FORMULAS

Companion to `gameplan.md`. Every card in the locked 100 that produces a number, written as a formula you can evaluate at the table.

1. Symbols

Symbol	Meaning
W	The Scarlet Witch's power (base 2)
R	Total generic cost reduction = W + 1 (Ruby Medallion) + 1 (Longshot)
MV	Mana value of the spell as it sits on the stack (X counts at its announced value)
X	The value you announce for an X-spell
S	Spells you've cast this turn
L	Lands you control
P	Opponents still alive — normally 3
Λ	Total life your opponents have lost this turn (all of them combined)
D	Your devotion to red — red pips on permanents you control

×2 if Solphim is out applies to every noncombat damage number aimed at an opponent or a permanent an opponent controls. It does **not** double damage to you or your own creatures.

2. The master cost formula

Cost of an instant/sorcery = printed cost − R	(generic portion only)
R = W + 1 (Ruby Medallion) + 1 (Longshot)	

Wanda's share only applies at MV ≥ 4. Ruby Medallion (red spells) and Longshot (noncreature spells) apply at every mana value. Coloured pips can never be reduced.

Board state	R (generic off)
Wanda alone, base power	2
Wanda + Ruby Medallion	3
Wanda + Ruby + Longshot	4
Wanda at 3 (one Forge counter) + Ruby + Longshot	5
Wanda at 6 (Livaan off a 4-drop) + Ruby + Longshot	8

3. Crackle with Power — the master table

xxx🔥🔥 → **5×X damage to each of up to X *different* targets.**

Mana needed = 3X + 2 - R	
Max X you can afford = [(available mana - 2 + R) ÷ 3]	
Damage per target = 5X	(×2 with Solphim)
MV on the stack = 3X + 2	

X	Raw cost	R=3	R=4	R=5	R=8	Damage each	Targets
2	8	5	4	3	—	10	2
3	11	8	7	6	3	15	3
4	14	11	10	9	6	20	4
5	17	14	13	12	9	25	5
6	20	17	16	15	12	30	6
7	23	20	19	18	15	35	7
8	26	23	22	21	18	40 ← kill from full	8
9	29	26	25	24	21	45	9
10	32	29	28	27	24	50	10

The two numbers to memorise: every point of X costs **3 more generic**, and **X=8 is the kill** (40 damage). With **Solphim**, X=4 is the kill instead — that's 9 mana at R=5.

Targeting rules

- Targets must all be **different** (rule 601.2c). No doubling up on one player.
- Damage per target is **fixed at 5X** regardless of how many targets you pick. Choosing fewer

does *not* concentrate it.

- To put 20 on one player you need **X=4** and simply choose one target.

4. The three X rules

Situation	X	Cards
Paying a real cost — hard-cast, or flashback/escape where the cost = the mana cost	✔ you choose	Past in Flames, Will of the Jeskai, Underworld Breach (B4)
Copying a spell on the stack — the copy inherits X and can re-use targets	✔ free, same X	Pyromancer's Goggles, Increasing Vengeance, Repeated Reverberation, Return the Favor, Storm King's Thunder
Cast "without paying its mana cost"	✗ X = 0	Improvisation Capstone, Mizzix's Mastery, Electrodominance, Arcane Bombardment, Hit the Mother Lode (SB), Dance with Calamity (B4), Finale of Promise (B4)
"You may cast/play them" (you still PAY)	✔ you choose	Apex of Power , Jeska's Will, Commune with Lava, Ignite the Future (from hand)

Rule 107.3b: X is forced to 0 only when you pay *neither the mana cost nor an alternative cost that includes X*. Flashback and escape costs that equal the mana cost **include** X, so they're fine. Rule 707.10: a copy inherits "modes, targets, **the value of X**, and additional or alternative costs."

5. Mana engines — output per turn

Card	Output	Notes
Electro, Assaulting Battery	+1 ⚡ per instant/sorcery	Keeps ALL unspent red mana across steps and phases — the best of the group
Birgi	+1 ⚡ per spell	Any spell, creatures included. Kept until end of turn.
Urabrask	+1 ⚡ per instant/sorcery	Plus 1 damage to an opponent
The Vision and Scarlet Witch	+1 ⚡ per spell	Also grows itself — a real clock
Storm-Kiln Artist	+1 Treasure per instant/sorcery cast or copied	The only engine that counts <i>copies</i>
Ashling, Flame Dancer	loot per spell; 2nd resolution = 2 dmg to each opponent + their creatures; 3rd = ⚡⚡⚡⚡	Also keeps unspent red mana
Neheb, the Eternal	+Λ ⚡ at your postcombat main	Empties at end of that phase
Nykthos	2, ⚡: add D red	Devotion to red; a real board is D = 6–10
Mana Geyser	+1 ⚡ per tapped land opponents control	0 on an empty board, 12+ after a turn cycle
Jeska's Will	with commander: both — ⚡ per card in an opponent's hand and exile 3, play them this turn	
Brass's Bounty	+L Treasures, untapped	~14 at 5 mana after reduction
Rousing Refrain (SB)	⚡ per card in target opponent's hand, kept	
Rituals	Pyretic/Desperate ⚡⚡⚡ (net +1) · Seething Song ⚡⚡⚡⚡⚡ (net +2)	Cast on the kill turn only

Total per-spell yield with Electro + Birgi + Urabrask + The Vision all out: **4 red mana per instant/sorcery**, plus a Treasure from Storm-Kiln. At that point cheap spells are free and expensive ones are nearly free.

6. Damage sources as formulas

Card	Formula	Per opponent?
Crackle with Power	5X to each of up to X targets	choose
Chandra's Ignition	W to each other creature and each opponent	yes — and Wanda survives it
Thor, God of Thunder	MV of each noncreature spell you cast , to any target	one target, focusable
Longshot, Rebel Bowman	2 per noncreature spell cast	yes, each opponent
Fiery Inscription	2 per instant/sorcery	yes, each opponent
Urabrask	1 per instant/sorcery	one opponent
Ashling (2nd resolution/turn)	2 to each opponent and each of their creatures	yes
Fiery Confluence	3 modes, repeatable: 1 to each creature / 2 to each opponent / destroy artifact	6 to each opponent if all three
Volcanic Vision	MV of the returned card to each creature opponents control	one-sided sweeper
Electrodominance	X to any target + free-cast a spell of MV ≤ X	remember: that free cast forces X=0
Storm King's Thunder	copies your next instant/sorcery X times	force multiplier, not damage
Valakut, the Molten Pinnacle	3 per Mountain entering, needs 5+ other Mountains	any target
Shatterskull Smashing	X split among ≤2 creatures; 2X if X ≥ 6	creatures only
Apex of Power	no damage — exile 7, cast them by PAYING , and add +10 mana of one colour	the enabler; unplayed cards stay exiled

All of these double under Solphim except damage to your own permanents.

7. Pump — growing w

Card	Effect on W	Duration
Livaan, Cultist of Tiamat	+MV of each noncreature spell you cast	until end of turn, stacks per spell
Cait Sith, Fortune Teller	+MV of the exiled card, each combat	until end of turn
Runechanter's Pike	+X/+0 where X = instants and sorceries in your graveyard; first strike; equip 2	permanent (shrinks when Past in Flames / Will / Mizzix's / Bombardment exile the yard)
Monstrous Rage	+3/+1, and the Role token is +1/+1 permanently	permanent residue
Blackblade Reforged	+L/+L; equip 3 (legendary), not 7	permanent
Champion's Helm	+2/+2 and hexproof; equip 1	permanent
Commander's Plate	+3/+3 and protection from W/U/B/G; equip 3 for commander	permanent
Forge of Heroes	+1/+1 counter on a commander that entered this turn	permanent
Tyrite Sanctum	2, c : God + a +1/+1 counter; 4, c, sac: indestructible counter	permanent

Livaan is the engine. Cast a mana value 5 spell and Wanda is +5 for the rest of the turn — which is 5 off every subsequent spell, or +1.67 to your X. Cast three spells averaging MV 5 and she's a 17/3 giving 17 off.

Permanent pumps compound across games-long turns. Every Forge/Tyrite/Role counter is a mana saved on every X-spell forever.

8. Copy effects

Card	Copies	Keeps X?	Cost
Pyromancer's Goggles	×1, when its c pays for a red instant/sorcery	✓	free (one per turn)
Increasing Vengeance	×1 from hand, ×2 from the graveyard	✓	c / flashback 3c
Repeated Reverberation	×2	✓	2c
Return the Favor	×1 (and/or redirect)	✓	c + 1 per mode
Storm King's Thunder	×X on your next instant/sorcery	✓	Xc

Copies are not cast. So they do not trigger Thor, Longshot, Fiery Inscription, Livaan, Wiccan, Electro, Birgi or Urabrask. They do trigger Storm-Kiln Artist (which says "cast or copy") and Ashling (same wording).

9. Recursion

Card	What you get back	X-spells?
Past in Flames	flashback on every instant/sorcery in your yard, cost = mana cost	✔ X works
Will of the Jeskai	same, plus a wheel if you control your commander (choose both)	✔ X works
Mizzix's Mastery	exile one I/S from yard, cast a free copy ; overload for all	✗ X = 0
Improvisation Capstone	free-cast off the top; Paradigm = a free copy each first main phase	✗ X = 0
Arcane Bombardment	exiles an I/S at random per turn, copies the whole pile free	✗ X = 0
Underworld Breach (B4)	escape = mana cost + exile 3	✔ X works

10. How to count lethal

Three opponents at 40. You need **120 damage**, or 40 on the one who matters.

Total this turn =	
5X	(Crackle, per target)
+ W	(Chandra's Ignition, each opponent)
+ 2 × S	(Longshot, each opponent)
+ 2 × S	(Fiery Inscription, each opponent)
+ Σ MV	(Thor, focused on one target)
+ 6	(Fiery Confluence, each opponent)
× 2 if Solphim is out	

Three realistic kill lines:

- A. The clean one. Crackle at **X=8** = 40 to each of eight targets. Needs 21–23 mana depending on R. This is the default.
- B. The cheap one. Solphim + Crackle at **X=4** = 40 to each of four targets, for **9 mana** at R=5. Solphim halves the mana requirement of your entire deck.
- C. The Goggles one. Crackle at **X=2** with **Pyromancer's Goggles** = 10 + 10 to the *same* two players = **20 each for ~4 mana**. With Solphim, **40 each — two players dead for four mana**.
- D. No payoff needed. Thor + Longshot + Fiery Inscription out, chain six spells averaging MV 5: $6 \times 5 = 30$ focused (Thor) plus $6 \times 2 + 6 \times 2 = 24$ to *each* opponent. That's 72 spread and 30 focused without casting a single payoff card.

11. Rules gotchas that change the math

- 107.3a — X is the same for every **x** in a cost. Crackle at X=3 is **nine** generic, not three.

While on the stack, MV counts X at its announced value, so Crackle at X=3 is **MV 11** and Wanda discounts it.

- 107.3b — casting "without paying its mana cost" forces **X = 0**. Cost *reduction* is fine.
- 601.2c — the same target can't be chosen twice for one instance of "target." Crackle's targets

are all different. But a **copy is a separate spell**, so it may re-use the same targets.

- 601.2f — total cost = mana cost **or alternative cost**, plus increases, minus reductions.

So Wanda discounts flashback and escape costs too.

- 707.10 — a copy inherits modes, targets, **the value of X**, and alternative costs.
- 500.1 — the postcombat main phase happens **every turn whether or not you attack**. Neheb

triggers regardless.

- Mana empties at the end of each step and phase**. Neheb's pile is postcombat-main only. Electro

and Ashling explicitly override this for **red** mana; Birgi's override lasts until end of turn.

- Ancient Tomb** deals you 2 per activation. At 40 life that's cheap; late, it's real.
- Hexproof and protection do not stop wraths** — a wrath neither targets nor deals damage. Only

Mithril Coat (flash) and **Tyrite Sanctum**'s indestructible counter save Wanda.